

Dr. Sachin Vaidya

Postdoctoral Associate, MIT

✉ svaitya1@mit.edu 📞 +1 (703)-853-9533 🌐 sachinvaidya.com

I investigate quantum and photonic systems that lie at the frontiers of current understanding. For advancing this effort, I combine theoretical and numerical techniques with emerging AI- and robotics-based approaches to unlock new modes of scientific discovery. My research interests broadly include topological quantum matter, nanophotonics, interpretable AI, and robotics.

Academic Experience

-
- | | |
|--|-----------------------|
| Massachusetts Institute of Technology
<i>Postdoctoral Associate</i> | <i>2023 – present</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ◦ Research interests: Topological Quantum Matter, Nanophotonics, AI and Robotics ◦ Advisor: Prof. Marin Soljačić | |
| NSF AI Institute for Artificial Intelligence and Fundamental Interactions
<i>IAIFI Junior Investigator</i> | <i>2023 – present</i> |
| Pennsylvania State University
<i>Graduate Research Assistant</i> | <i>2019 – 2023</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ◦ Research interests: Topological Photonics, Photonic Crystals ◦ Advisor: Prof. Mikael C. Rechtsman ◦ Thesis committee: Prof. Chao-xing Liu, Prof. Eric Hudson, Prof. Chris Giebink ◦ Received several fellowships and awards based on excellence in coursework and research. | |
| Pennsylvania State University
<i>Graduate Teaching Assistant</i> | <i>2017 – 2019</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ◦ Teaching assistant for five undergraduate physics courses over four semesters ◦ Received the Graduate Teaching Assistant Award for Teaching Excellence in Physics | |
| National Center for Radio Astrophysics, Pune, India
<i>Visiting Student</i> | <i>2016</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ◦ Project: Towards understanding radio mode feedback in galaxy clusters | |
| National Physical Laboratory, New Delhi, India
<i>Research Fellow</i> | <i>2015</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ◦ Project: Designing, modeling, and testing an effusive Ytterbium atomic oven. | |

Education

-
- | | |
|--|--------------------|
| Pennsylvania State University
<i>Ph.D., Physics</i> | <i>2017 – 2023</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ◦ Thesis: Topological photonic crystals in one, two, and three dimensions | |
| University of Hyderabad
<i>M.Sc., Physics (Integrated Bachelors+Masters program)</i> | <i>2012 – 2017</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ◦ Thesis: A stochastic approach to simulating the complex modulus of viscoelastic fluids ◦ Specialization: Quantum optics and photonics | |

Awards, Honors and Fellowships

Awards and Honors

- David H. Rank Memorial Physics Award, Penn State (2018)
Awarded to excellent students based on their academic performance in graduate school.
- Graduate Teaching Assistant Award, Penn State (2018)
Awarded for teaching excellence based on the feedback of hundreds of students.
- University Medal in Physics, University of Hyderabad (2017)
Honor equivalent to summa cum laude.

Fellowships

- David C. Duncan Graduate Fellowship in Physics, Penn State (2022)
Awarded for excellence in research and coursework.
- Downsborough Graduate Fellowship in Physics, Penn State (2022 and 2021)
Recognizes the accomplishments of outstanding graduate students.
- Troxell Scholarship in Physics, Penn State (2017)
Awarded to exceptional incoming Ph.D. candidates based on their graduate school application.
- Homer F. Braddock Fellowship, Penn State (2017)
Awarded to exceptional incoming Ph.D. candidates based on their graduate school application.
- CSIR-NET Junior Research Fellowship, All-India rank: 42 (2016)
Awarded based on a nationwide competitive exam; Rank indicates top 1% standing.
- Indian Academy of Sciences Summer Research Fellowship (2015)
Awarded to conduct research at a prominent research institution in India over one summer period.

Grants and Funding

Co-wrote multiple funded proposals securing over \$2M across U.S. funding agencies (DARPA, ONR, ARO, NSF, and industry initiatives). Managed strategic aspects for several grants, including review meeting presentations, budgeting, deliverables, and progress reports.

- Co-wrote grant with Prof. Marin Soljačić (and other PIs) titled “*Deep nanophotonic inference systems*” – ARO MURI 2026 (funded).
- Co-wrote grant with Prof. Marin Soljačić (and other PIs) titled “*Agentic AI for scientific co-pilots in materials*” – Shell MITEI proposal 2025 (funded, \$280k).
- Co-wrote grant with Prof. Marin Soljačić, and Prof. Pulkit Agrawal titled “*Generative AI for Automated Experimental Setup and Alignment in Optics and Beyond*” – MIT Generative AI Impact Consortium (MGAIC) 2025 (funded, \$100k).
- Co-wrote grant with Prof. Marin Soljačić titled “*Bridging Statistical Physics and Generative AI: Scaling Laws, Robustness, and Spectral Control*” – MIT Generative AI Impact Consortium (MGAIC) 2025 (funded, \$150k).
- Co-wrote grant with Prof. Marin Soljačić and Prof. Riccardo Comin titled “*Enhanced superconductivity via bound-states-in-the-continuum*” – DARPA QUAMELEON 2024 (funded, \$150k).
- Co-wrote grant with Prof. Marin Soljačić titled “*Quantum light and nanophotonic scintillation*” – DARPA PhENOM 2024 (funded, \$325k).
- Co-wrote grant with Prof. Mikael Rechtsman titled “*Limitations on disorder and leveraging aperiodicity in topological photonics and beyond*” – ONR regular program 2022 (funded, \$758k).
- Wrote a white paper with Prof. Marin Soljačić titled “*OptoMate: AI- and Robotics-Driven Automation for Optical Setup Assembly and Alignment*”.
- Managed deliverables of ongoing grants in Prof. Marin Soljačić’s group (review meeting presentations, progress reports) – (2023–2026).
- Contributed significantly to several other grants from industry, NSF, NIH, and DOD (in submission).

Publications

Links

[Google Scholar](#) | [arXiv](#) | [ORCID](#)

(*equal contribution, ■ lead/co-lead, †corresponding author)

Peer-Reviewed Publications

1. Seou Choi*, **Sachin Vaidya***[†], Caio Silva, Shiekh Zia Uddin, Sajib Biswas Shuvo, Shrish Choudhary, Marin Soljačić, *A Framework for Closed-Loop Robotic Assembly, Alignment and Self-Recovery of Precision Optical Systems*, **IROS (2026)** [🔗](#) - accepted
2. Shiekh Zia Uddin*, **Sachin Vaidya***[†], Shrish Choudhary, Zhuo Chen, Raafat K. Salib, Luke Huang, Dirk R. Englund, Marin Soljačić, *AI-driven robotics for optics*, **Science Advances (2026)** [🔗](#)
3. Seou Choi, **Sachin Vaidya**, Avner Shultzman, Charles Roques-Carmes, Ido Kaminer, Marin Soljačić, *Hybrid Nanophotonic Scintillators for Enhanced X-ray Absorption, Emission, and Time Resolution*, **ACS Photonics (2026)** [🔗](#)
4. André Grossi Fonseca*, Oriol Mayne i Comas*, **Sachin Vaidya**[†], Marin Soljačić, *Refining Heuristic Predictors of Fractional Chern Insulators using Machine Learning*, **Physical Review B (2026)** [🔗](#)
5. Ali Ghorashi*, **Sachin Vaidya***[†], Ziming Liu, Charlotte Loh, Thomas Christensen, Max Tegmark, Marin Soljačić, *Interpretable Artificial Intelligence for Topological Photonics*, **ACS Photonics (2026)** [🔗](#)
6. Joshua Chen, **Sachin Vaidya**, Simo Pajovic, Seou Choi, William Michaels, Louis Martin-Monier, Juejun Hu, Carol Cogswell, Charles Roques-Carmes, Marin Soljačić, *Wavefront Engineering for Scintillation-Based Imaging*, **ACS Photonics (2026)** [🔗](#)
7. J. Lukas K. König*, Kang Yang*, André Grossi Fonseca, **Sachin Vaidya**, Marin Soljačić, Emil J. Bergholtz, *Exceptional Topology on Nonorientable Manifolds*, **Physical Review Research (2026)** [🔗](#)
8. **Sachin Vaidya***[†], André Grossi Fonseca*, Mark R. Hirsbrunner, Taylor L. Hughes, Marin Soljačić, *Quantized electromagnetic-crystalline responses in insulators*, **Physical Review Letters (2025)** [🔗](#) – Editors’ Suggestion
9. Yannick Salamin, Gaojie Yang, Brian Mills, André Grossi Fonseca, Charles Roques-Carmes, Quansan Yang, Justin Beroz, Steven Kooi, Marc de Miguel Comella, Kiran Mak, **Sachin Vaidya**, Daniel Oran, Corban Swain, Yi Sun, Shai Maayani, Jamison Sloan, Amel Amin Elfadil Elawad, Josue Lopez, Edward Boyden, and Marin Soljačić, *Three-Dimensional Nanophotonics with Spatially Modulated Optical Properties*, **Light: Science & Applications (2025)** [🔗](#).
10. Ki Young Lee, Stephan Wong, **Sachin Vaidya**, Terry A. Loring, Alexander Cerjan, *Classification of Fragile Topology Enabled by Matrix Homotopy*, **Physical Review Research (2025)** [🔗](#)
11. Sahil Pontula, **Sachin Vaidya**, Charles Roques-Carmes, Shiekh Zia Uddin, Marin Soljačić, Yannick Salamin, *Non-reciprocal frequency conversion in a multimode nonlinear system*, **Nature Communications (2025)** [🔗](#)
12. Ahmet Kemal Demir*, Luca Nessi*, **Sachin Vaidya**, Connor Occhialini, Marin Soljačić, Riccardo Comin, *Tunable Nanophotonic Devices and Cavities based on a 2D Magnet*, **Nature Photonics (2025)** [🔗](#) – Phys.org [🔗](#), MIT News [🔗](#), MRL Newsletter [🔗](#)
13. Louis Martin-Monier*, Simo Pajovic*, Muluneh G. Abebe*, Joshua Chen, **Sachin Vaidya**, Seokhwan Min, Seou Choi, Steven E. Kooi, Bjorn Maes, Juejun Hu, Marin Soljačić, Charles Roques-Carmes, *Large-scale self-assembled nanophotonic scintillators for X-ray imaging*, **Nature Communications (2025)** [🔗](#)
14. Seokhwan Min, Seou Choi, Simo Pajovic, **Sachin Vaidya**, Nicholas Rivera, Shanhui Fan, Marin Soljačić, Charles Roques-Carmes, *End-to-end design of multicolor scintillators for enhanced energy resolution in X-ray imaging*, **Light: Science & Applications 14, 158 (2025)** [🔗](#)
15. Ziming Liu, Yixuan Wang, **Sachin Vaidya**, Fabian Ruehle, James Halverson, Marin Soljačić, Thomas Y. Hou, Max Tegmark, *KAN: Kolmogorov-Arnold networks*, **ICLR (2025)** [🔗](#) – Scientific American [🔗](#), Quanta Magazine [🔗](#), MIT Technology Review [🔗](#), IEEE Spectrum [🔗](#)
16. Ali Ghorashi, **Sachin Vaidya**, Mikael Rechtsman, Wladimir Benalcazar, Marin Soljačić, Thomas Christensen, *Prevalence of two-dimensional photonic topology*, **Physical Review Letters (2024)** [🔗](#)
17. André Grossi Fonseca*, **Sachin Vaidya***[†], Thomas Christensen, Mikael C. Rechtsman, Taylor L. Hughes, Marin Soljačić, *Weyl points on non-orientable manifolds*, **Physical Review Letters (2024)** [🔗](#)

18. Maria Barsukova*, Fabien Gris *, Zeyu Zhang*, **Sachin Vaidya**, Jonathan Guglielmon, Michael I. Weinstein, Li He, Bo Zhen, Randall McEntaffer, Mikael C. Rechtsman, *Direct observation of Landau levels in silicon photonic crystals*, [Nature Photonics](#) (2024) [Phys.org](#) [News & Views](#) [Penn State News](#) [↗](#)
19. **Sachin Vaidya**[†], Mikael C. Rechtsman, Wladimir A. Benalcazar, *Polarization and weak topology in Chern insulators*, [Physical Review Letters](#) (2024) [↗](#)
20. **Sachin Vaidya**[†], Christina J rg*, Kyle Linn, Megan Goh, Mikael C. Rechtsman, *Reentrant delocalization transition in one-dimensional photonic quasicrystals*, [Physical Review Research](#) (2023) [↗](#)
21. **Sachin Vaidya**[†], Ali Ghorashi, Thomas Christensen, Mikael C. Rechtsman, Wladimir A. Benalcazar, *Topological phases of photonic crystals under crystalline symmetries*, [Physical Review B](#) (2023) [↗](#)
22. Christina J rg*, **Sachin Vaidya***, Jiho Noh, Alexander Cerjan, Shyam Augustine, Georg von Freymann, Mikael C. Rechtsman, *Observation of quadratic (charge-2) Weyl point splitting in near-infrared photonic crystals*, [Laser & Photonics Reviews](#) (2022) [↗](#) – [Featured on the cover](#) [↗](#)
23. Alexander Cerjan*, Christina J rg*, **Sachin Vaidya**, Shyam Augustine, Wladimir A. Benalcazar, Chia Wei Hsu, Georg von Freymann, Mikael C. Rechtsman, *Observation of bound states in the continuum embedded in symmetry bandgaps*, [Science Advances](#) (2021) [↗](#)
24. Julian Schulz, **Sachin Vaidya**, Christina J rg, *Topological photonics in 3D micro-printed systems*, [APL Photonics](#) (2021) [↗](#) – Editor’s pick
25. **Sachin Vaidya**[†], Wladimir A. Benalcazar, Alexander Cerjan, Mikael C. Rechtsman, *Point-defect-localized bound states in the continuum in photonic crystals and structured fibers*, [Physical Review Letters](#) (2021) [↗](#)
26. **Sachin Vaidya**[†], Jiho Noh*, Alexander Cerjan, Christina J rg, Georg von Freymann, Mikael C. Rechtsman, *Observation of a charge-2 photonic Weyl point in the infrared*, [Physical Review Letters](#) (2020) [↗](#) – Editors’ Suggestion

Preprints

1. Manxi Shi*, **Sachin Vaidya**[†], Ali Ghorashi, Steven G. Johnson, Marin Solja   , *Three-dimensional confinement of light in photonic crystals without bandgaps*, [arXiv:2607.23281](#) (2026) [↗](#)
2. Serena Landers, Sahil Pontula, Shiekh Zia Uddin, **Sachin Vaidya**, Marin Solja   , Steven G. Johnson, *CLUSTER: Derivative-free optimization of smooth functions with parameter-change costs*, [arXiv:2606.20498](#) (2026) [↗](#)
3. Archer Wang, Joshua Chen, **Sachin Vaidya**, Marin Solja   , *End-to-End Optimization of Incoherent Imaging for Classification Under Detector-Limited Readout*, [arXiv:2606.09792](#) (2026) [↗](#)
4. **Sachin Vaidya**[†], Alaa Bayazeed*, Andr  Grossi Fonseca, Adolfo G. Grushin, Marin Solja   , Christina J rg, *Non-Hermiticity-induced chirality imbalance of Weyl Landau levels*, [arXiv:2606.00615](#) (2026) [↗](#)
5. Seou Choi*, **Sachin Vaidya**[†], Charles Roques-Carmes, Marin Solja   , *Supercollimating photonic crystal scintillators*, [arXiv:2605.17006](#) (2026) [↗](#)
6. Kyle Linn*, Megan Goh*, **Sachin Vaidya**, Christina J rg, Mikael C. Rechtsman, *Topological pumping through a localized bulk in a photonic Hofstadter system*, [arXiv:2603.22697](#) (2026) [↗](#)
7. Andr  Grossi Fonseca*, Eric Wang*, **Sachin Vaidya**, Patrick J. Ledwith, Ashvin Vishwanath, Marin Solja   , *Gradient-based search of quantum phases: discovering unconventional fractional Chern insulators*, [arXiv:2509.10438](#) (2025) [↗](#)
8. Jamison Sloan*, **Sachin Vaidya**[†], Nicholas Rivera, Marin Solja   , *Noise immunity in quantum optical systems through non-Hermitian topology*, [arXiv:2503.11620](#) (2025) [↗](#)

Submitted

➔ Draft available upon request

1. Kyle Linn, Jonas Karcher, **Sachin Vaidya**, Christina J rg, Jaeuk Kim, Paul Steinhardt, Salvatore Torquato, and Mikael C. Rechtsman, *Transparency in a one-dimensional disordered stealthy-hyperuniform photonic medium* (2026)
2. Ahmet Kemal Demir, Luca Nessi, **Sachin Vaidya**, Marin Solja   , Riccardo Comin, *Magnetic Exciton-Based On-Chip Optical Attenuators* (2026)

Patents

1. *Scintillator Metalens for High-Resolution Scintillation-Based Imaging*, U.S. provisional patent application No. 64/008,275, MIT (2026)
2. *Supercollimating photonic crystal scintillators*, U.S. provisional patent application No. 63/960,449, MIT (2026)
3. *Automated robotic system for the assembly, fine-alignment, and characterization of optical setups*, U.S. provisional patent application No. 63/745,115, MIT (2025)

Service and Outreach

Peer Review

Served as a referee for 60+ articles in these journals: Springer Nature (Nature Physics, Nature Communications, Communications Physics), APS (Physical Review Letters, Physical Review X, Physical Review A, Physical Review B, Physical Review Applied, Physical Review Research), AAAS (Science Advances), Optica (Optica, Photonics Research, Optics Express), AIP (APL Photonics, Applied Physics Letters, Journal of Applied Physics), Wiley (Advanced Optical Materials, Laser & Photonics Reviews), Oxford (National Science Review), IOPScience (Journal of Physics: Photonics), ACM (ACM Computing Surveys)

Proposal Review

Served as an external expert reviewer for 20+ user proposals submitted to the Center for Integrated Nanotechnologies (CINT) at Sandia National Laboratories (2023–present).

Conference Organization

- MRS Fall Meeting (2026, *upcoming*) – Symposium organizer for *Topology Beyond Periodicity: From Aperiodic to Interacting Systems* with Dr. Alexander Cerjan, Prof. Terry Loring and Prof. Wladimir Benalcazar
- APS Global Physics Summit (2026) – Session chair for *Insulators & Tensor Networks for Topological Properties*
- APS March Meeting (2024) – Session chair for *Topological Crystalline Insulators: Theory and Experiment*
- CLEO (2024) – Session chair for *Optoelectronic Nanodevices*

Outreach

- Scientific mentor and technology lead, MIT Innovation Teams (iTeams) program – provided laboratory technology as a commercialization case study and met regularly with interdisciplinary student team (2026)
- Invited to contribute input to the Committee on Atomic, Molecular, and Optical Sciences (CAMOS) of the National Academies on “21st Century Tools at the Interface of Atomic, Molecular, and Optical Science and Quantum Information Science” (2026)
- Invited by MIT News to provide expert commentary on a published paper (2025)
- NSF IAIFI Talent Forum Board Member (2025–present)
- MIT Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program (UROP) mentor (2023–present)
- Penn State Research Experience for Undergraduates (REU) mentor (2019–2022)
- NSF MRSEC outreach team member, Penn State (2019–2020)
- Co-founder of the science club “ETHER” (Engaging Talks on Highly Exciting Research), University of Hyderabad (2015–2017)

Teaching and Mentoring

Pedagogical Training

- Kaufman Teaching Certificate Program, MIT, Fall 2026–present (*ongoing*)
- Pedagogy for Physicists, graduate-level course, Penn State, Spring 2018

Teaching Assistant

Conducted ten one-hour recitation sessions per week throughout the semester for the following undergraduate courses. Received the Graduate Teaching Assistant Award based on hundreds of student evaluations.

- Wave Motion and Quantum Mechanics, Penn State, Fall 2018
- Fluids and Thermal Physics, Penn State, Fall 2018
- Mechanics and Intro Physics Laboratory, Penn State, Summer 2018
- Mechanics, Penn State, Spring 2018
- Introductory Physics, Penn State, Fall 2017

Graduate Mentoring

1. Ryan Lopez (MIT Graduate Student, 2025–present), Visual reasoning for optical laboratories using multi-modal language models
2. Victoria Zhang (MIT Graduate Student, 2025–present), Anderson localization of quantum noise
3. Joshua Chen (MIT Graduate Student, 2024–present), [Wavefront engineering for scintillation imaging](#) 
4. Seou Choi (MIT Graduate Student, 2024–present), [Supercollimating photonic crystal scintillators](#) 
5. Ali Ghorashi (MIT Graduate Student, 2023–2025), [Interpretable AI for topological photonics](#) 
6. André Grossi Fonseca (MIT Graduate Student, 2023–2025), [Weyl points on non-orientable manifolds](#) 
7. Maria Barsukova (Penn State Graduate Student, 2022–2023), [Landau levels in photonic crystals](#) 
8. Zeyu Zhang (Penn State Graduate Student, 2022–2023), [Landau levels in photonic crystals](#) 

Undergraduate Mentoring

1. Jehyeon Shin (Exchange student at MIT, Summer 2026–Spring 2027), Optics simulator integration for autonomous laboratories
2. Caio Silva (MIT Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program, Fall 2025–present), [Robotics for automated construction of optical cavities](#) 
3. Luka Protulipac (Exchange student at MIT, Summer 2025), Benchmarking and comparison of symbolic regression methods
4. Amelie Chan (MIT Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program, Fall 2024–present), Enhancements in surface-roughened scintillators
5. Yichen (Sophie) Li (MIT Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program, Fall 2024–Fall 2025, Summer 2026), Non-Hermitian skin effect in strained Weyl semimetals
6. Taohan Lin (MIT Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program, Fall 2024–present), Neural wave functions using Kolmogorov-Arnold Networks
7. Eric Wang (MIT Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program, Fall 2024–Summer 2025), [Gradient-based search of quantum phases](#) 
8. Luke Huang (MIT Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program, Fall 2024–Spring 2025), [AI-driven robotics for free-space optics](#) 
9. Oriol Mayne i Comas (Erasmus Intern, Fall 2024–Summer 2025), [Refining Heuristic Predictors of Fractional Chern Insulators using Machine Learning](#) 
10. Raafat Salib (MIT Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program, Spring 2024–Summer 2025), [AI-driven robotics for free-space optics](#) 
11. Shrish Choudhary (MIT Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program, Spring 2024–Summer 2025), [AI-driven robotics for free-space optics](#) 
12. Manxi (Maggie) Shi (MIT Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program, Fall 2023–Summer 2025), [Three-dimensional confinement of light in photonic crystals without bandgaps](#) 
13. Kyle Linn (Penn State Research Experience for Undergraduates, Summer 2022), [Reentrant delocalization transition in 1D photonic quasicrystals](#) 

14. Megan Goh (Penn State Research Experience for Undergraduates, Summer 2022), [Hofstadter butterfly and chiral edge states in 1D photonic crystals](#) 
15. Alison Weiss (Penn State Research Experience for Undergraduates, Summer 2020 and 2021), [Searching for near-IR Fermi arcs in a photonic chiral woodpile](#) 

Conference Presentations and Talks

Invited Talks

- *Overcoming bottlenecks in physics with interpretable AI and robotics* – CINT User Meeting (September 2026), Santa Fe, New Mexico
- *Overcoming bottlenecks in physics with interpretable AI and robotics* – Yale Quantum Institute (YQI) talk at Yale University (April 2026), New Haven, Connecticut
- *A Weyl'd story about chirality* – Noncommutative Topology and Quantum Materials at University of New Mexico (March 2026), Albuquerque, New Mexico
- *Overcoming the experimental bottleneck with AI and robotics* – AMOS Seminar at Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory (January 2026), Berkeley, California
- *Interpretable AI and robotics for photonics* – Emerging Directions in Optical Computing and Information Processing at CUNY (June 2025), Virtual
- *Interpretable AI and robotics for photonics* – Quantum computing for artificial intelligence (QC-AI) Seminar at RPTU Kaiserslautern-Landau (June 2025), Virtual
- *Interpretable AI and robotics for physics and photonics applications* – SPIE Photonics West (January 2025), San Francisco, California
- *Topological treks through non-orientable spaces and noisy landscapes* – Condensed matter physics seminar at Emory University (November 2024), Atlanta, Georgia
- *Frontiers in nanophotonics, quantum optics, and interpretable AI for physics* – CINT colloquium at Sandia National Laboratories (October 2024), Albuquerque, New Mexico

Invited Group Meeting Talks

- *Interpretable AI and robotics for photonics* – University of Maryland (May 2025), College Park, Maryland (Host: Prof. Mohammad Hafezi)
- *Interpretable AI and robotics for physics* – UCLA (March 2025), LA, California (Host: Prof. Di Luo)
- *Emerging paradigms in nanophotonics* – University of California, Berkeley (October 2024), Berkeley, California (Hosts: Prof. Boubacar Kante and Prof. Eli Yablonovitch)
- *Advances in topological insulators and semimetals* – Stanford University (June 2024), Stanford, California (Host: Prof. Shanhui Fan)
- *Weyl points in photonic crystals* – virtual (December 2022) (Host: Prof. Adolfo Grushin)
- *Topological photonic crystals in one, two and three dimensions* – MIT (October 2022), Cambridge, Massachusetts (Host: Prof. Marin Soljačić)

Contributed Conference Talks

- *AI-driven robotics for optics* – APS Global Physics Summit (2026), Denver, Colorado
- *Supercollimating photonic crystal scintillators* – SPIE Photonics West (January 2026), San Francisco, California
- *AI-driven robotics for physics* – NSF IAIFI Summer Workshop at Harvard University (2025), Cambridge, Massachusetts
- *Volumetrically-patterned nanophotonic scintillators* – CLEO (2025), Long Beach, California
- *Unidirectional flow of quantum noise through non-reciprocity* – APS Global Physics Summit (2025), Anaheim, California
- *Weyl points on non-orientable manifolds* – MRS Fall Meeting (2024), Boston, Massachusetts
- *Photonic Weyl points on non-orientable Brillouin zones* – CLEO (2024), Charlotte, North Carolina

- *Localization and reentrant delocalization transitions in one-dimensional photonic quasicrystals* – APS March Meeting (2024), Minneapolis, Minnesota
- *Polarization-induced topological edge and corner states in Chern photonic crystals* – CLEO (2023), San Jose, California
- *Photonic Chern and Weyl systems in multilayer structures via dimensional extension* – CLEO (2023), San Jose, California
- *Polarization and corner charge in Chern insulators* – APS March Meeting (2023), Las Vegas, Nevada
- *Point-defect localized photonic bound states in the continuum* – DAMOP (2021), Virtual Conference
- *Observation of charge-2 photonic Weyl point* – CLEO (2020), Virtual Conference

Grant Review Presentations

- *New developments in topological matter and photonics* – ONR MURI Review (2025), University of Maryland, College Park, Maryland
- *Robustly controlling quantum noise & development of nanophotonic scintillators* – DARPA PhENOM phase 1 program review (2025), Virtual
- *Non-reciprocal topological control of quantum noise* – DARPA PhENOM quarterly program review (QPR) (2024), Virtual
- *Development of advanced nanophotonic scintillators* – DARPA PhENOM Kickoff Meeting (2024), Virtual
- *Advances in topological band theory* – ONR MURI Review (2024), Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
- *Novel topological phases in photonic crystals* – ONR MURI Review (2023), Los Angeles, California
- *Observation of quadratic Weyl point splitting in 3D micro-printed photonic crystals* – ONR MURI Review (2021), Virtual

Other Talks and Posters

- *Overcoming the experimental bottleneck with AI and robotics* – NSF IAIFI Journal Club at MIT (2026), Cambridge, Massachusetts
- *Volumetric photonic crystal scintillators* (poster) – MRS Fall Meeting (2024), Boston, Massachusetts
- *Topological phases on the real projective plane* (poster) – APS March Meeting (2024), Minneapolis, Minnesota
- *Symmetry-indicator invariants: bridging the gap in topological band theory* – MIT CMT Journal Club (2023), Cambridge, Massachusetts
- *Weyl points in 3D photonic crystals* – Peter Eklund Award Finalist at Penn State (2023)
- *Quantized polarization and fractional corner charge in Chern insulators* – Office of Naval Research (ONR) MURI Seminar (2022), Virtual
- *Weyl points and BICs in 3D micro-printed photonic crystals* – Nanoscribe User Meeting (2021), Virtual
- *Point-defect localized photonic bound states in the continuum* (poster) – Office of Naval Research (ONR) MURI Poster Session (2021), Virtual
- *Towards understanding radio mode feedback in galaxy clusters: catalogue of radio sources and their properties* – Visiting Students' Research program (VSRP) seminar, NCRA-TIFR (2016), Pune, Maharashtra

References

Prof. Marin Soljačić

Cecil and Ida Green Professor of Physics
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
✉ soljadic@mit.edu

Prof. Mikael C. Rechtsman

Professor of Physics and Associate Head for Research
Pennsylvania State University
✉ mcr22@psu.edu

Prof. Taylor L. Hughes

Professor of Physics and Willett Faculty Scholar
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
✉ hughest@illinois.edu

Prof. Mohammad Hafezi

Minta Martin Professor of Physics
University of Maryland
✉ hafezi@umd.edu

Prof. Riccardo Comin

Associate Professor of Physics
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
✉ rcomin@mit.edu

Prof. Terry Loring

Distinguished Professor of Mathematics and Statistics
University of New Mexico
✉ tloring@unm.edu
